



Shiromani Akali Dal

The **Shiromani Akali Dal** (**SAD**) (translation: *Supreme Eternal Party*^[19]) is a centre-right Sikh-centric state political party in Punjab, India. The party is the second-oldest in India, after Congress, being founded in 1920.^{[20][21][22]} Although there are many parties with the description *Akali Dal*, the party that is recognised as "Shiromani Akali Dal" by the Election Commission of India is the one led by Sukhbir Singh Badal. The party has a moderate Punjabi agenda.^[23] On 26 September 2020, it left the National Democratic Alliance over the farm bills.^[24]

History

British India

Akali Dal was formed on 14 December 1920 as a task force of the Shiromani Gurudwara Prabandhak Committee, the Sikh religious body. The Akali Dal considers itself the principal representative of Sikhs. Sardar Sarmukh Singh Chubbal was the first president of a unified proper Akali Dal, but it became popular under Master Tara Singh.^[25] Akali movement influenced 30 new Punjabi newspapers launched between 1920 and 1925.^[26]

In the provincial election of 1937, the Akali Dal won 10 seats. The Khalsa Nationalists won 11 seats and joined the coalition government headed by the Unionist leader Sikander Hyat Khan. The Akalis sat in opposition and made occasional forays into reaching an understanding with the Muslim League, which never reached fruition.^[27]

In the provincial election of 1946, the Akali Dal won 22 seats and joined the coalition government headed by the Unionist Khizar Hayat Khan Tiwana, along with the Indian National Congress. The Muslim League was unable to capture power, despite having won the largest number of seats, which perhaps suited

Shiromani Akali Dal



President	<u>Sukhbir Singh Badal</u>
Lok Sabha Leader	<u>Harsimrat Kaur Badal</u>
Founded	14 December 1920
Headquarters	Block #6, Madhya Marg Sector 28, <u>Chandigarh</u>
Newspaper	<u>Akali Awaaz</u>
Student wing	<u>Student Organisation of India</u> ^[1]
Youth wing	<u>Youth Akali Dal</u>
Women's wing	<u>Istri Akali Dal</u> ^[2]
Labour wing	<u>Shiromani Akali Dal SC wing</u> ^[3]
Peasant's wing	<u>Shiromani Akali Dal BC wing</u> ^[4]
Ideology	<u>Conservatism</u> ^{[5][6]} <u>Punjabiya</u> ^{[7][8][9][10]} <u>Punjabi nationalism</u> ^{[11][12]} <u>Federalism</u> ^{[13][14]}
Political position	<u>Centre-right</u> ^{[15][16]} to <u>right-wing</u> ^[17]
Colours	■ Navy Blue & Saffron
ECI Status	<u>State Party</u> ^[18]
Alliance	<u>SAD+BSP</u> (2021-2023) <u>SAD+INLD</u> (2021-Present) <u>NDA</u> (1998–2020)
Seats in Rajya Sabha	0 / 245
Seats in Lok Sabha	1 / 543
Seats in Punjab Legislative	2 / 117

it fine as it strengthened its Pakistan demand. The Muslim League launched a civil disobedience campaign, bringing down the Tiwana government by March 1947. The rest of the period till Indian independence was filled by Governor's Rule.^[28]

As with other Sikh organisations, Master Tara Singh and his Akali Dal strongly opposed the partition of India, which he thought would create an environment of possible persecution.^[29]

Assembly

Election symbol



Website

www.shiromaniakalidal.com (<http://www.shiromaniakalidal.com>)

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Post Independence India

In the 1950s, the party launched the Punjabi Suba movement, demanding a state with majority of Punjabi speaking people, out of undivided East Punjab under the leadership of Sant Fateh Singh.^[30] In 1966, the present Punjab was formed. Akali Dal came to power in the new Punjab in March 1967,^[31] but early governments didn't live long due to internal conflicts and power struggles within the party. Later, party strengthened and party governments completed full term.

Modern Factions

Sukhdev Singh Dhindsa along with other Akali leaders came together at a Gurdwara in Ludhiana on 7 July 2020 to re-establish SAD (D). Dhindsa was chosen as president of the revived political party. He claimed SAD (D) as the true Shiromani Akali Dal and that the one so called was taken over by the Badal family.^[32]

Prior to this in late 2018, expelled senior members of Shiromani Akali Dal Ranjit Singh Brahmpura, Rattan Singh Ajnala, Sewa Singh Sekhwan, their relatives and others had formed SAD (T).^[33] The reasoning of the expelling was due to their accusations of the Badal family steering Shiromani Akali Dal in the wrong path.

Ahead of the 2022 Punjab Legislative Assembly election, both SAD (T) and SAD (D) were dissolved to be merged together into a new political party by the name of Shiromani Akali Dal (Sanyukt). This party entered into the National Democratic Alliance to contest the Punjab elections alongside the candidates of Bharatiya Janata Party.

Ideology

Shiromani Akali Dal's main goals are the protection of Sikh rights, Punjab's waters, and opposition to the Sutlej Yamuna link canal.^[34]



Poster released in 1921 by the Secretary Akali Dal, appealing to all Akali factions to unite or face extinction, Amritsar, circa June 1921. Digitised by the [Panjab Digital Library](#).

1996 Moga Conference

In 1996, at a historic conference in Moga, Shiromani Akali Dal adopted a moderate Punjabi agenda and shifted party headquarters from [Amritsar](#) to [Chandigarh](#).^[35]

Shiromani Akali Dal (Punar Surjit)

On August 11, 2025, the breakaway faction of Shiromani Akali Dal was solidified as a separate political group through the unanimous election of former Jathedar of the Akal Takht, Giani Harpreet Singh, as the President of the faction. Bibi Satwant Kaur, the daughter of [Sikh martyr](#), 'Bhai' [Amrik Singh](#), was declared as the chairperson of the Panthic Council. This breakaway faction of Shiromani Akali Dal included multiple prominent leaders, such as [Prem Singh Chandumajra](#), [Bibi Jagir Kaur](#), [Parminder Singh Dhindsa](#), and sitting [MLA](#) [Manpreet Singh Ayali](#).^[36]

Shiromani Akali Dal (Punar Surjit)	
Abbreviation	SAD (PS)
Leader	Giani Harpreet Singh
Founded	11 August 2025
Headquarters	182/80 Industrial Area Phase I, Chandigarh , 160002
Colours	Navy Blue
Politics of India · Political parties · Elections	

The early platform of this political group encompassed plans to address the issues of [Shiromani Gurdwara Parbandhak Committee](#) elections, the release of [Sikh](#) political prisoners, and justice regarding [Guru Granth Sahib](#) desecration. Giani Harpreet Singh stated that the faction will attempt to get the faction registered by [ECI](#) as the official 'Shiromani Akali Dal'.^[37]

Party Presidents

Following is the list of presidents of the party as given on the party website.

S. No.	Name	Portrait	Term Start	Term End	Duration
1	Sarmukh Singh Jhabal	--	17 February 1969	27 March 1970	1 year, 1 month, 10 days 405 days
2	<u>Kharak Singh</u>		--	--	--
3	<u>Master Tara Singh</u>		--	--	--
4	<u>Gopal Singh Qaumi</u>		--	--	--
5	Tara Singh Thethar	--	--	--	
6	<u>Teja Singh Akarpuri</u>		--	--	--
7	<u>Babu Labh Singh</u>	--	--	--	
8	<u>Udham Singh Nagoke</u>		--	--	--
9	Giani Kartar Singh	--	--	--	
10	Pritam Singh Gojran (Gujran Sangrur)	--	--	--	
11	<u>Hukam Singh</u>	--	--	--	
12	<u>Fateh Singh</u>	--	--	--	
13	Achar Singh	--	--	--	
14	Bhupinder Singh	--	--	--	
15	<u>Mohan Singh Tur</u>		--	--	--
16	<u>Jagdev Singh Talwandi</u>		--	--	--
17	<u>Harchand Singh Longowal</u>		--	20 August 1985	--

18	<u>Surjit Singh Barnala</u>		27 September 1985	1996	11 years, 9 months, 15 days (4,291 days)
19	<u>Parkash Singh Badal</u>		1996	2008	12 years (4,383 days)
20	<u>Sukhbir Singh Badal</u>		2008	2024	16 years, 2 months (5,927 days)
21	<u>Balwinder Singh Bhunder</u>		2024	2025	1 year, 2 months and 15 days (441 days)
22	<u>Sukhbir Singh Badal</u>		12 April 2025	Present	7 months and 12 days

Current Members in Houses

House	Current Members	Leader
Union Parliament		
<u>Lok Sabha</u>	1	<u>Harsimrat Kaur Badal</u>
State Legislature		
<u>Punjab Legislative Assembly</u>	1 / 117	<u>Ganieve Kaur Majithia</u>

List of Union Leaders

No.	Portrait	Name	Term in office		Duration	Portfolio	Prime Minister
1		<u>Parkash Singh Badal</u>	26 March 1977	27 March 1977	1 day	<u>Minister of Communications</u>	<u>Morarji Desai</u>
			28 March 1977	17 June 1977	81 days	<u>Minister of Agriculture and Irrigation</u>	
2		<u>Surjit Singh Barnala</u>	18 June 1977	28 July 1979	2 years, 40 days		
			19 March 1998	13 October 1999	1 year, 208 days	<u>Minister of Chemicals and Fertilizers</u> <u>Minister of Food and Consumer Affairs</u>	
3		<u>Sukhbir Singh Badal</u>	20 March 1998	13 October 1999	1 year, 207 days	<u>Minister of State in the Ministry of Industry</u>	<u>Atal Bihari Vajpayee</u>
4		<u>Sukhdev Singh Dhindsa</u>	22 November 1999	26 November 1999	4 days	<u>Minister of Works and Estates</u> <i>(Merged with Ministry of Urban Development)</i>	
			7 November 2000	22 May 2004	3 years, 197 days	<u>Minister of Chemicals and Fertilizers</u>	
			27 May 2000	7 November 2000	164 days	<u>Minister of Mines</u>	
			2 February 2000	7 November 2000	279 days	<u>Minister of Youth Affairs and Sports</u>	
5		<u>Harsimrat Kaur Badal</u>	27 May 2014	30 May 2019	5 years, 3 days	<u>Minister of Food Processing Industries</u>	<u>Narendra Modi</u>
			31 May 2019	18 September 2020	1 year, 110 days		

List of Chief Ministers

Sr. No.	Portrait	Chief Minister	Constituency	In Office		Duration
				From	To	
1		<u>Gurnam Singh</u> (1899–1973)	<u>Qila Raipur</u>	17 February 1969	27 March 1970	1 year, 38 days
2		<u>Surjit Singh Barnala</u> (1925–2017)	<u>Barnala</u>	29 September 1985	11 June 1987	1 year, 255 days
3		<u>Parkash Singh Badal</u> (1927–2023)	<u>Gidderbaha</u>	27 March 1970	14 June 1971	1 year, 79 days
				20 June 1977	17 February 1980	2 years, 242 days
			<u>Lambi</u>	12 February 1997	26 February 2002	5 years, 14 days
				1 March 2007	14 March 2012	5 years, 13 days
				14 March 2012	16 March 2017	5 years, 2 days

List of Deputy Chief Ministers

Sr. No.	Name (constituency) (birth-death)	Portrait	Term of office			Chief Minister	Appointed by
1	<u>Sukhbir Singh Badal</u> (-) (born 1962)		21 January 2009	1 July 2009	161 days	<u>Prakash Singh Badal</u>	<u>S. F. Rodrigues</u>
2	<u>Sukhbir Singh Badal</u> (Jalalabad) (born 1962)		10 August 2009	14 March 2012	2 years, 217 days		<u>Shivraj Patil</u>
			14 March 2012	16 March 2017	5 years, 2 days		

General Elections

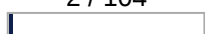
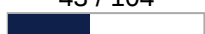
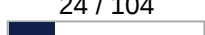
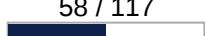
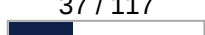
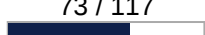
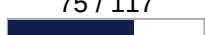
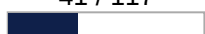
General Elections Results					
Year	General Election	Seats Won	Change in # of Seats	Percentage of Vote	Vote Swing
1945	6th Central Legislative Assembly	2	—	—	—
1951	1st Lok Sabha	4	▲ 2	0.99%	—
1957	2nd Lok Sabha	0	▼ 4	—	—
1962	3rd Lok Sabha	3	▲ 3	0.72%	—
1967	4th Lok Sabha	3	—	—	—
1971	5th Lok Sabha	1	▼ 2	0.87%	—
1977	6th Lok Sabha	9	▲ 8	1.26%	—
1980	7th Lok Sabha	1	▼ 8	0.71%	—
1984	8th Lok Sabha	7	▲ 6	17.9%	—
1989	9th Lok Sabha	0	▼ 7	—	—
1991	10th Lok Sabha	0	—	—	—
1996	11th Lok Sabha	8	▲ 8	0.76%	—
1998	12th Lok Sabha	8	—	0.81%	—
1999	13th Lok Sabha	2	▼ 6	25.58%	—
2004	14th Lok Sabha	8	▲ 6	34.28%	—
2009	15th Lok Sabha	4	▼ 4	0.96%	—
2014	16th Lok Sabha	4	—	20.30%	▼ 13.55%
2019	17th Lok Sabha	2	▼ 2	27.45%	▲ 13.9%
2024	18th Lok Sabha	1	▼ 1	13.42%	▼ 14.03%

In state elections

Punjab Provincial Assembly Elections

Legislative Assembly elections								
Election Year	Leader	seats contested	seats won	+/- in seats	Overall votes	% of overall votes	+/- in vote share	Sitting side
1937	Master Tara Singh	81	11 / 175	—	1,788,856	5.58	—	Others
1946	Master Tara Singh	81	20 / 175	▲ 9	3,550,212	10.94	▲ 5.36	Others

Punjab Legislative Assembly Elections

Legislative Assembly elections								
Election Year	Leader	seats contested	seats won	+/- in seats	Overall votes	% of overall votes	+/- in vote share	Sitting side
<u>1952</u>	<u>Gopal Singh Khalsa</u>	48	13 / 126 	▲ 13	620,455	12.44	▲ 12.44	Opposition
<u>1957</u>	Contested with Congress and 28 Akali leaders won. ^[38]							
<u>1962</u>	<u>Gurnam Singh</u>	46	16 / 154 	▲ 16	799,925	11.87	▲ 11.87	Opposition
<u>1967</u>	<u>Sant Fateh Singh (SFSG)</u>	59	24 / 104 	▲ 24	871,742	20.48	▲ 20.48	Opposition
	<u>Master Tara Singh (MTSG)</u>	61	2 / 104 	▲ 2	178,746	4.20	▲ 4.20	
<u>1969</u>	<u>Gurnam Singh</u>	65	43 / 104 	▲ 43	1,381,916	29.36	▲ 29.36	Government
<u>1972</u>	<u>Jaswinder Singh Brar</u>	72	24 / 104 	▼ 19	1,344,437	27.64	▼ 1.72	Opposition
<u>1977</u>	<u>Parkash Singh Badal</u>	70	58 / 117 	▲ 34	1,776,602	31.41	▲ 3.8	Government
<u>1980</u>	<u>Harchand Singh Longowal</u>	73	37 / 117 	▼ 21	1,683,266	26.92	▼ 4.49	Opposition
<u>1985</u>	<u>Surjit Singh Barnala</u>	100	73 / 117 	▲ 23	2,630,270	38.01	▲ 11.09	Government
<u>1992</u>	Boycotted the elections ^{[39][40][41]}							
<u>1997</u>	<u>Parkash Singh Badal</u>	92	75 / 117 	▲ 75	3,873,099	37.64	▲ 37.64	Government
<u>2002</u>			41 / 117 	▼ 34	3,196,924	31.08	▼ 6.56	Opposition
<u>2007</u>		93	48 / 117 	▲ 7	4,689,018	37.09	▲ 6.01	Government
<u>2012</u>		94	56 / 117 	▲ 8	4,828,612	34.73	▼ 2.36	Government
<u>2017</u>			15 / 117 	▼ 41	3,898,161	25.2	▼ 9.4	Others
<u>2022</u>	<u>Sukhbir Singh Badal</u>	97	1 / 117 	▼ 12	2,861,286	18.38	▼ 6.86	Others

Haryana Legislative Assembly Elections

Legislative Assembly elections								
Election Year	Leader	seats contested	seats won	+/- in seats	Overall votes	% of overall votes	+/- in vote share	Sitting side
<u>2009</u>	Charanjeet Kaur Mallour	2	1 / 90	—	9,490,092	0.98	—	Opposition
<u>2014</u>	Balkaur Singh	5	1 / 90	—	12,426,968	0.6	▼ 0.38	Coalition
<u>2019</u>	Rajinder Singh Desujodha	3	0 / 90	▼ 1	12,520,177	0.38	▼ 0.22	Extra-parliamentary

Delhi Legislative Assembly Elections

Legislative Assembly elections								
Election Year	Leader	seats contested	seats won	+/- in seats	Overall votes	% of overall votes	+/- in vote share	Sitting side
<u>2013</u>	Manjinder Singh Sirsa	4	1 / 70	—	7,699,800	1	—	Government
<u>2015</u>	Manjinder Singh Sirsa	1	0 / 90	▼ 1	8,978,269	0.5	▼ 0.5	Extra-parliamentary

Core Committee

Sr. No.	Name (constituency) (birth)	Portrait	Term of office		
1	<u>Sarabjeet Singh Jhinjer</u> (-) (born 1982)		08 June 2023	16 July 2024	1 year, 38 days

See also

- Splinter groups of the Akali Dal
- Sikhism
- Tara Singh
- Babu Labh Singh
- Akali (disambiguation)
- Shiromani Akali Dal (Sanyukt)
- List of political parties in India

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